Johan Galtung and His Structural Theory of Imperialism

Galtung[25] presents his version of imperialism as a relation between a Centre and a Periphery. The relationship is unequal and his theory tried to illuminate on the structure of this unequal relationship, which resists any change in the *status quo*. It is this inequality that results in the formation of a centre and a periphery and he contends that those in power in the centre have a community of interest with those in power in the periphery. The consequence that follows is a kind of relationship that operates at the expense of the majority of the people in the peripheral countries, but this primarily serves the interest of the majority of the people in the centre countries.

The basic assumptions of Galtung are:

1. Harmony of interest between the centre in the Centre nation and the centre in the Periphery nation.
2. Disharmony of interest within the Periphery nation than within the Centre nations.
3. Disharmony of interest between the periphery in the Centre nation and the periphery of the Periphery nation.

He depicted this relation diagrammatically as in Figure 2.2.

